

Inside 1,000 Startups

What the TrustMRR revenue data actually says about who is making money

\$13.5M

aggregate MRR

\$133.8M

revenue, last 12 months

500,597

active subscriptions

65

countries represented

What we are actually looking at

Every startup connects a live payment provider, so revenue is verified rather than self-reported.

1

Money

MRR, 30-day / 3-month / 12-month / all-time revenue, growth rates, active subscriptions

2

Business model

Value proposition, problem solved, pricing model, target persona, B2B vs B2C, category

3

Distribution

Domain rating, X followers, 30-day visitors, revenue per visitor, country

4

Liquidity

On-sale flag, asking price, revenue multiple — a live market for these businesses

Coverage warning: the fields are not equally populated

100%

revenue & MRR

76%

country

73%

category

71%

domain rating

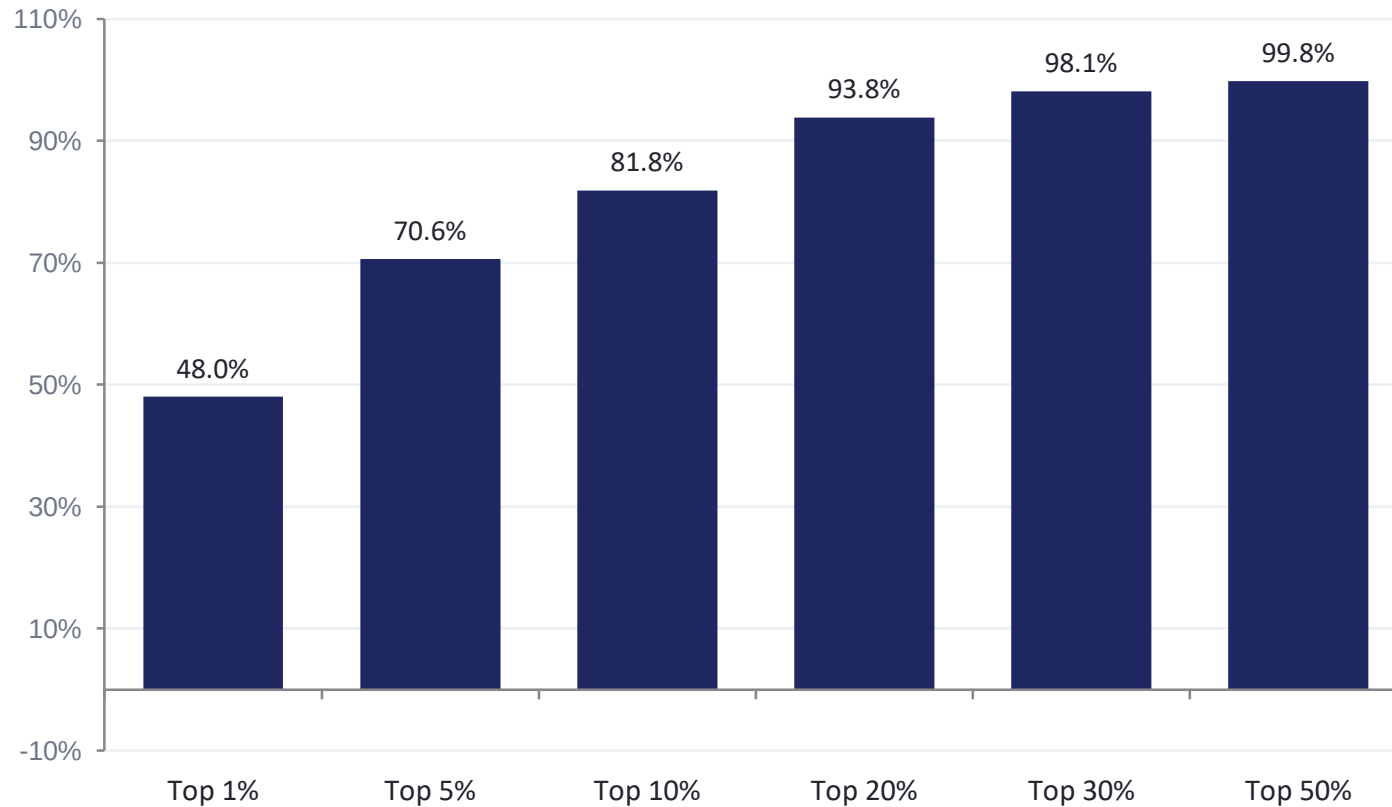
18%

web traffic

■ FINDING 01

Revenue is a brutal power law

The top 10 companies out of 1,000 earn more than the other 990 combined.



48%

of all MRR sits with the single largest company, Stan

\$282

median monthly recurring revenue across the cohort

0.2%

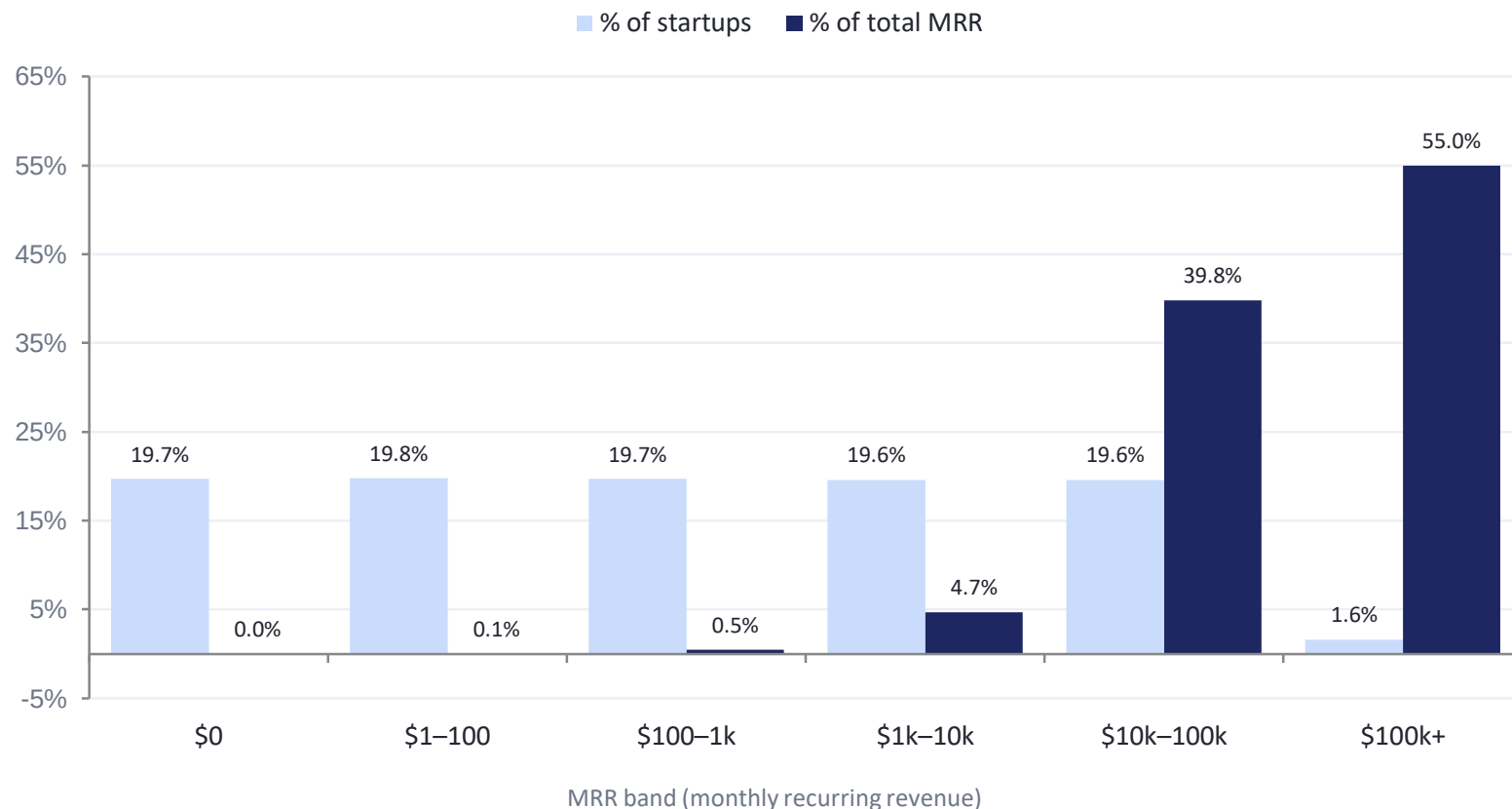
of MRR earned by the entire bottom half of the list

Averages are meaningless here. Mean MRR is \$13,472 — 48x the median.

■ FINDING 02

Four out of five startups earn under \$10k a month

The cohort splits cleanly into a long tail of experiments and a thin layer of real businesses.



Read this way

- 197 startups report zero MRR — a fifth of the list has connected billing but no recurring revenue.
- 16 companies above \$100k/month carry 55% of the cohort's recurring revenue.
- The \$10k–100k band is the real middle class: 196 companies, 40% of MRR.
- 162 startups show no revenue at all in the last 30 days.

■ FINDING 03

Most of the cohort is standing still

Median 30-day MRR growth is exactly 0%. Momentum concentrates where revenue already exists.

43%

flat — no change in MRR month over month

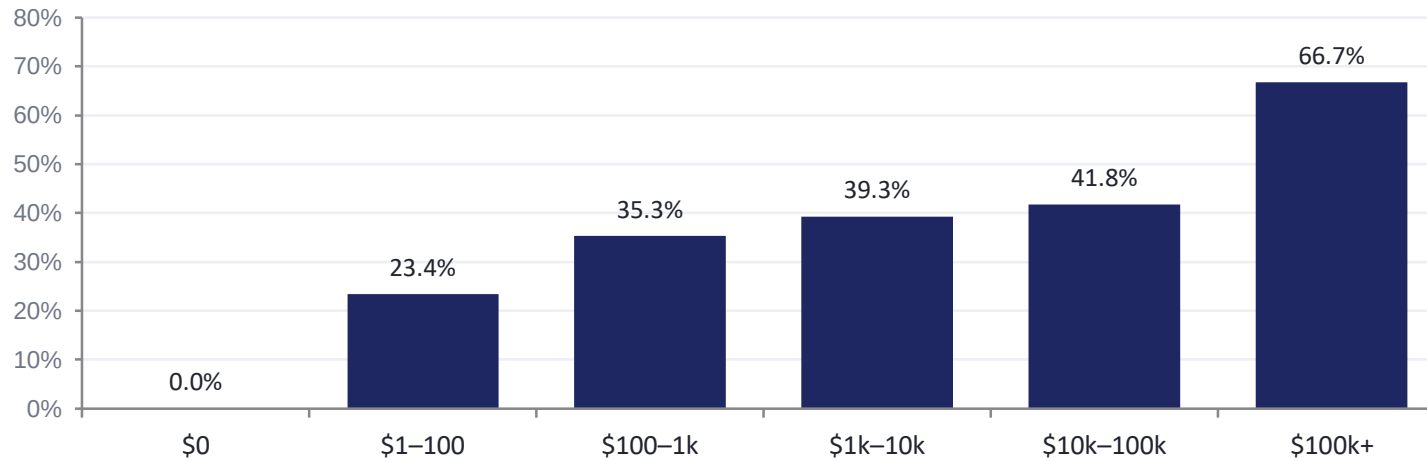
27%

shrinking — MRR down over 30 days

31%

growing — only 15% grew faster than 20%

Share of startups growing month over month, by revenue band



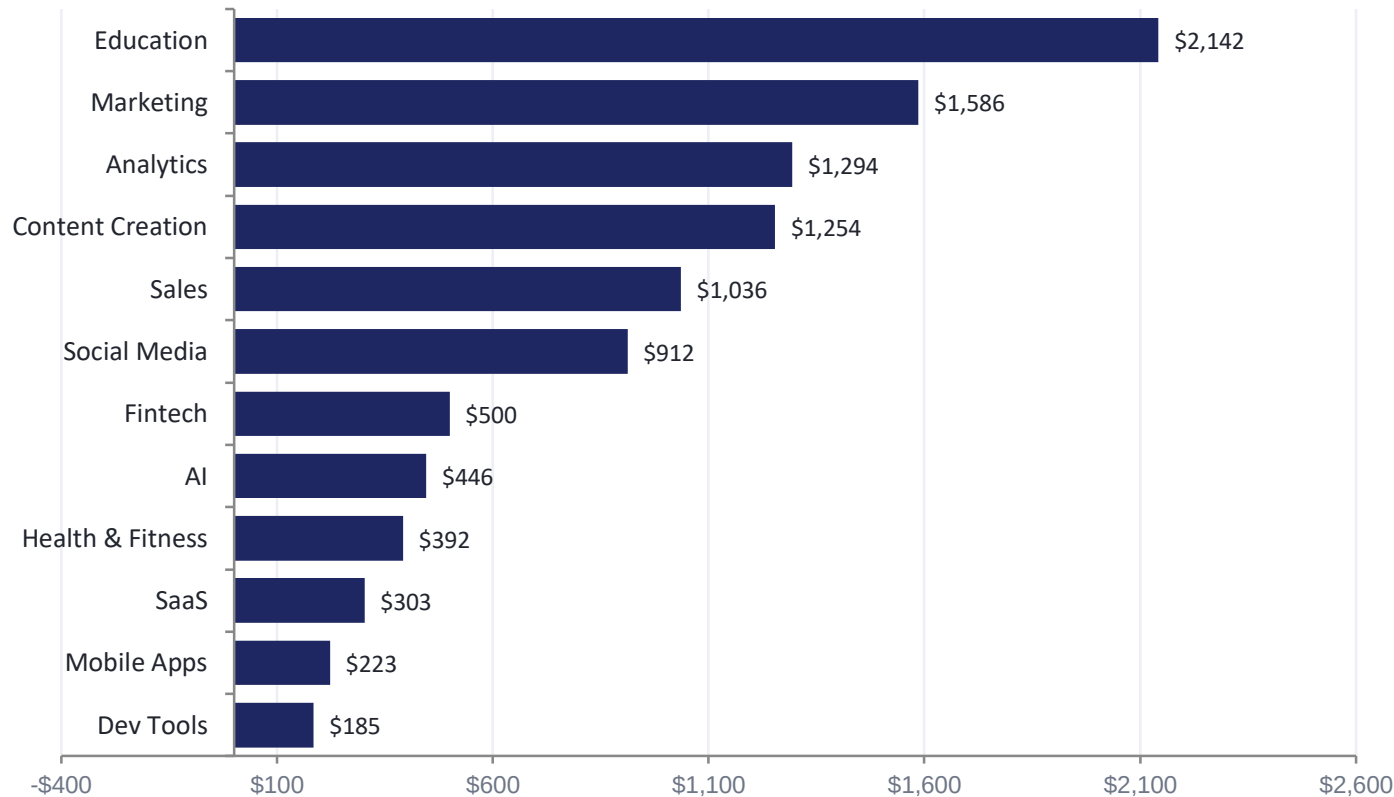
Growth compounds upward

- A startup above \$10k MRR is roughly twice as likely to be growing as one under \$100.
- Two-thirds of the \$100k+ tier is still growing at scale.
- 55% of revenue-generating startups are running ahead of their trailing-year pace; 26% are behind it.

■ FINDING 04

AI is the most crowded category, not the richest

AI accounts for 27% of tagged startups. Education, Marketing and Analytics earn more per company.



197

AI startups — the largest single category, and the most competitive

\$18.4M

12-month revenue from AI: the biggest pool, spread thinnest

Education

highest median MRR at \$2,142 and the deepest subscriber bases

Dev Tools

lowest median MRR, but the fastest median growth at +8.9%

■ FINDING 05

B2B is one third of the cohort and nearly two thirds of the money

Consumer startups win on volume of companies; business startups win on revenue per customer.

B2B

255 startups · 36% of tagged

\$1,036 median MRR

\$49 revenue per subscriber

58% of all tagged MRR

16 median active subscriptions

B2C

401 startups · 56% of tagged

\$181 median MRR

\$9 revenue per subscriber

36% of all tagged MRR

19 median active subscriptions

Both

56 startups · 8% of tagged

\$352 median MRR

\$23 revenue per subscriber

6% of all tagged MRR

22 median active subscriptions

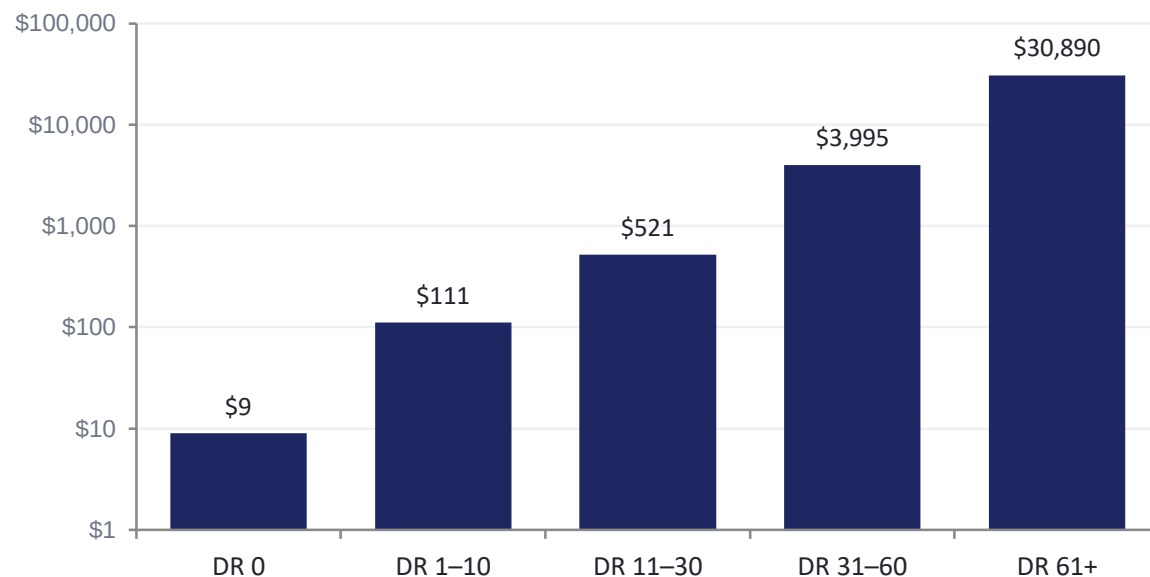
The pricing tell: 53% of startups that describe their pricing offer a free tier — and they run a median MRR of \$159 against \$751 for those that do not.

■ FINDING 06

Owned distribution predicts revenue. Social following does not.

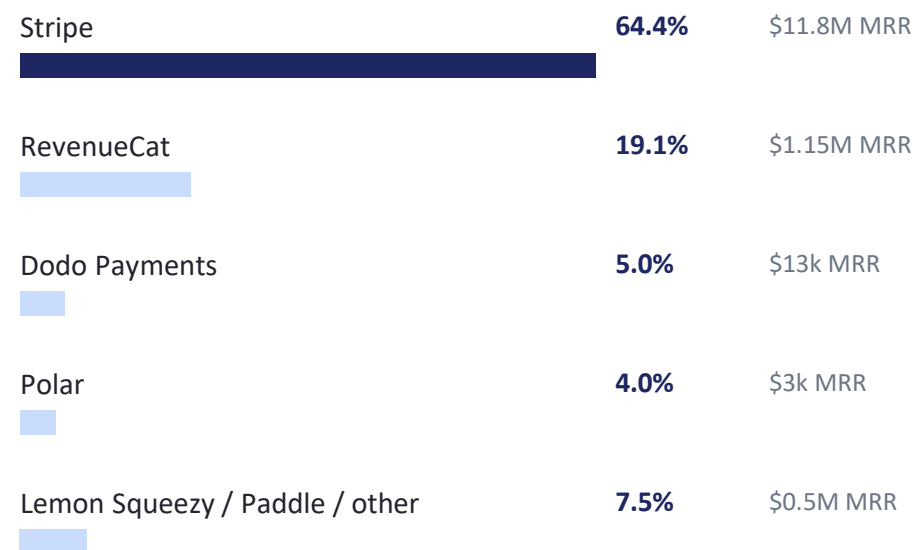
Domain authority tracks revenue closely; X follower counts barely move with it.

Median MRR by domain rating



Log scale · correlation with revenue 0.48, versus 0.18 for X followers

Where the money is collected

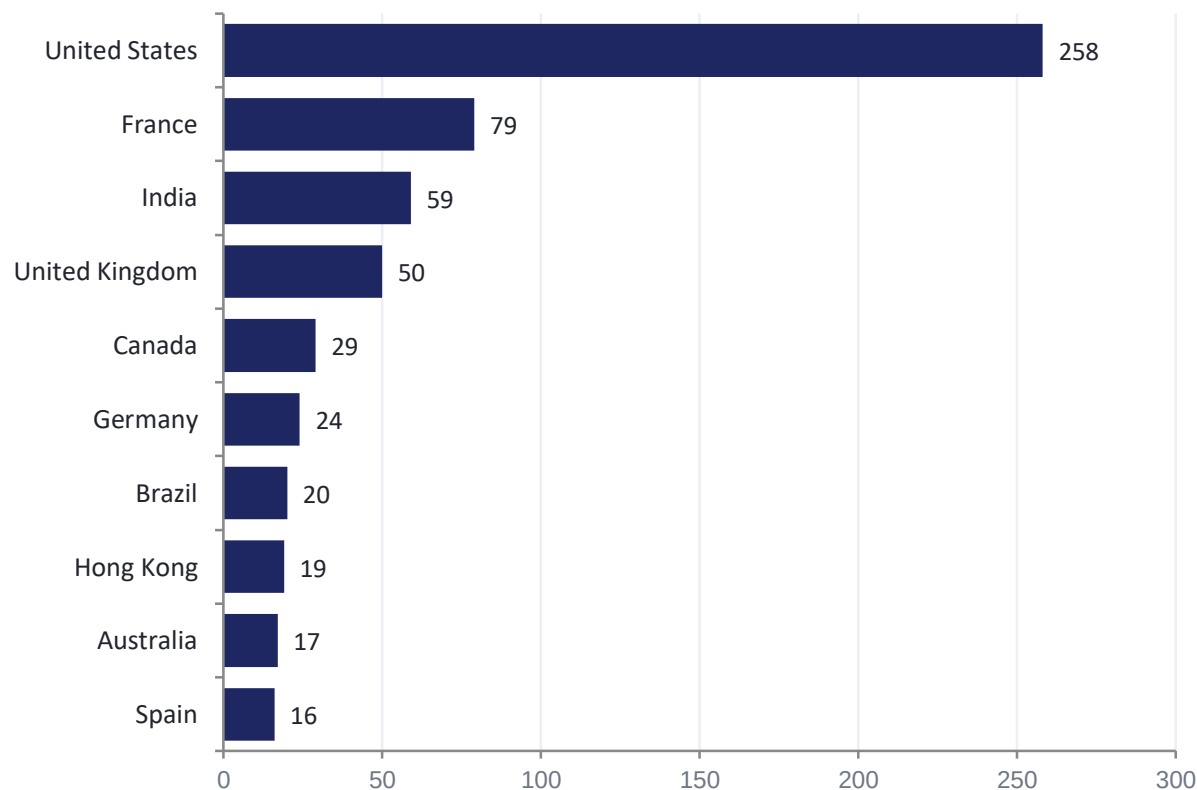


Consumer-mobile stacks skew differently: Superwall users show a median 1,534 subscriptions but low prices, while Stripe carries 88% of the cohort's MRR.

■ FINDING 07

American startups dominate the revenue, not the headcount

The US is a third of the located startups and more than 70% of located MRR.



\$7.5M

US total MRR — 71% of all located revenue

\$1,263

US median MRR, the highest of any major market

\$6

India's median MRR across 59 startups — high volume, early stage

241

records with no country at all, a quarter of the dataset

■ FINDING 08

A quarter of these startups are for sale

262 listings, \$86.8M in combined asking price, at a median of 2.3x annual revenue.

262

startups listed for sale (26%)

\$86.8M

combined asking price

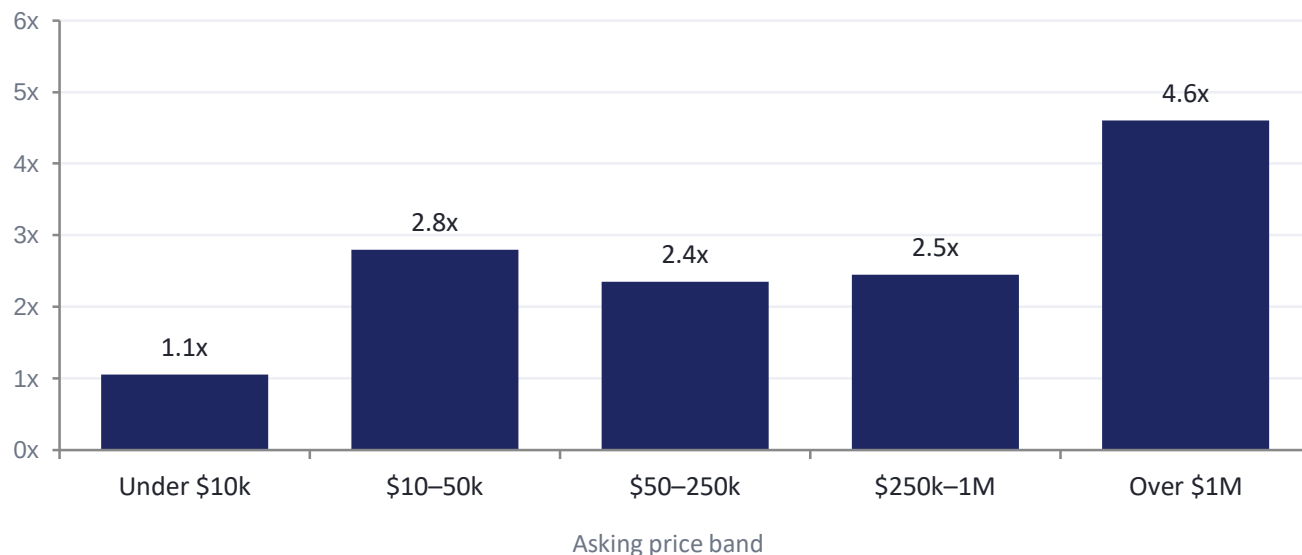
\$35,000

median asking price

2.3x

median revenue multiple

Bigger businesses command bigger multiples



261 of 262 listings disclose an asking price

What sellers look like

- Listed startups are materially larger: \$1,055 median MRR versus \$187 for those not on sale.
- 96 listings sit under \$10,000 and price at just 1.05x revenue — near-abandoned assets.
- 21 listings ask over \$1M and command 4.6x, the premium for scale and durability.
- AI and Mobile Apps are the most-listed categories — 83 of the 262 listings.

Four things this data cannot tell you

The revenue figures are verified. Almost everything around them is partial.



Survivorship

Only startups that voluntarily connect a payment provider appear here. Failures and the privately profitable are both invisible.



Sparse traffic data

Visitors are recorded for 178 startups and revenue-per-visitor for 142. Any acquisition-efficiency conclusion rests on 14% of the sample.



Anonymous entries

129 records are labelled Stealth Company, several with six-figure MRR. They carry no category, persona or country.



A single 30-day window

Growth rates come from one month, ranging from -100% to +12,983%. Treat them as noisy signals, not trends.

Five conclusions

01

Scale, not survival, is the hard part

Reaching \$1k MRR is common — 40% of the cohort clears it. Reaching \$10k is rare, and \$100k is a rounding error at 1.6%.

02

Momentum is bought with revenue

The likelihood of growing rises at every band, from 23% under \$100 MRR to 67% above \$100k. Distress does not reverse itself.

03

Crowded is not the same as lucrative

AI has the most companies and the thinnest median. Education, Marketing and Analytics quietly out-earn it per company.

04

Charge businesses, or charge more

B2B is a third of the companies and 58% of the money, at 5× the revenue per subscriber.

05

Owned distribution is the real moat

Domain authority tracks revenue across every band. Social following barely does. SEO beats reach.